



Figure 1: StencylWorks welcome centre

standard folder for manually installed programs on most distributions. That's it.

Next, let us unpack the StencylWorks tar.gz with a `tar-xz /StencylWorks-1.3.4.tar.gz` command in the folder where you downloaded the package. Unpacking the tar.gz gives you a directory `StencylWorks-1.3.4.tar.gz_FILES`; change the working directory (`cd`) into that and run `/StencylWorks` to launch StencylWorks. When it starts, you'll be asked to accept the licence agreement. Accept it and you'll land up at the welcome screen (Figure 1).

Now that you have StencylWorks running, you will want to start creating your first game, but you don't know how to begin. From the official site, you can get a number of tutorials on every aspect of this tool. If you want an interactive tutorial that takes a step-by-step approach to creating games, visit <http://www.stencyl.com/help/viewCategory/1> to check Abigail's interactive tutorial. This five-part series is ideal for newcomers and within a few hours you will learn a lot about this tool—and at the same time, you'll have your first game running. The tool also comes with a few game kits and a crash-course kit that assists you in learning the game creation process.

StencylWorks provides a nice drag-and-drop interface for creating the logic behind your game, so you don't need to write code if you don't want to. It provides blocks under different categories, which you can use to add interactivity to your games. All game-related tasks, including character movements, saving and reloading your game can be done using these blocks. You simply create actors, scenes and sounds for your game, and import them to the StencylWorks workspace. To add functionality to your game, just drag-drop the appropriate blocks, and the corresponding ActionScript code is automatically generated.

You can also convert your games into mobile games and deploy them to various app stores in order to earn some bucks for your efforts. On the official site, you can read some success stories that'll inspire you, and you'll realise how a properly planned and executed idea can achieve success.

Having read this article, I am quite sure you must be itching



Figure 2: The StencylWorks drag-drop interface

to get your hands on StencylWorks. So what are you waiting for? Go get it, and enjoy making up some cool games! 

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